

Animal Welfare Standards and Guidelines for Livestock at Processing Facilities and Establishments

The Queensland Department of Agriculture and Fisheries (DAF) is leading the development of this standard. An independent consultant is finalising the scientific literature review. The AWTG approved the Terms of Reference for the Stakeholder Advisory Group (SAG) and an independent facilitator. The SAG will review the drafting group's preliminary standards and guidelines and provide advice and recommendations to the AWTG. The independent facilitator will manage stakeholder engagement across the stakeholder consultation processes. DAF is currently progressing invitations for the SAG appointments and procuring an independent facilitator for the group.

Suitability of horses under existing Australian Animal Welfare Standards and Guidelines for Land Transport of Livestock

DAF is also leading a review of this standard. Amended standards and guidelines and accompanying Regulation Impact Statement (RIS) are being drafted.

Virtual Fencing Technology

AWTG has begun examining the use of virtual fencing technology – GPS-enabled neckband or collar devices worn by livestock producing mild electric pulses to deter animals from approaching or crossing a virtual fence boundary – in response to a formal referral from the Agriculture Senior Officials' Committee (AGSOC). Some jurisdictions have modified regulations permitting the use of specific products. AWTG is examining regulatory harmonisation across jurisdictions.

Further Information

Contact the secretariat: awtg@aff.gov.au

Post: AWTG c/- Department of Agriculture, Forestry and Fisheries,
GPO Box 858, Canberra ACT 2601, Australia

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/animal/welfare/awtg/communique-october-2021>